TOKYO · FUJI FIVE LAKES



Mt. Fuji Day Trip Guide from Tokyo

Trains, buses, the 8 best places, ready-made itineraries, local food and rainy-day plans

Every fare and time checked on official sites and by phone · November 2026

富士

序

WELCOME

Before you start

Every fare, timetable and opening time in this guide was checked in **November 2026** against official websites or by phone with the operators themselves. Where we use another source, we say so.

Prices and times in Japan do change, often in spring (when timetables are revised) and when tax or fuel costs change. **Before you travel, check the official websites** mentioned in each section, especially for trains, buses and opening days.

From the author

I made this guide because the information on getting to Mt. Fuji is spread across dozens of Japanese websites, and quick online answers are often out of date or simply wrong. The text was written with the help of AI tools, but I checked every fare, timetable and opening time myself, on official websites and by phone with the railway and bus companies, museums, hot springs and tourist offices, in November 2026. I hope it saves you time and lets you enjoy the mountain. — **Tama**

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This guide is an independent travel guide. It is not affiliated with any of the companies or places it mentions.

要点

ESSENTIALS

Know Before You Go

These are the points that most often catch travelers out, and that quick online answers often get wrong or leave out. We checked each one with the operators themselves in November 2026. Details are in the chapters shown.

	What to know	Chapter
1	**Fuji Excursion train: board Cars 1–3 only.** The other cars go somewhere else.	2
2	**Japan Rail Pass covers Shinjuku–Otsuki only.** Otsuki to Kawaguchiko costs ¥1,770 extra (fare + express fee). Children's express fee on this section is ¥400.	2
3	**Miss your highway bus and the ticket is void.** No later bus, no refund. Change or cancel before departure.	2
4	**No big suitcases on the sightseeing buses.** Use the coin lockers right outside Kawaguchiko Station's ticket gates (¥700–1,200).	2
5	**Red Line only? Don't buy the 1-Day Pass.** Single tickets are cheaper. Buy it if you ride the Green or Blue Line.	2
6	**Chureito Pagoda is about 25 minutes on foot from Shimoyoshida Station,** including 398 steps.	3
7	**Oshino Hakkai: you may touch the water, but never throw coins in.**	3
8	**The ¥1,000-bill view at Lake Motosu is about 1 hour on foot from the bus stop.** Buses run about once an hour; last bus back 16:45.	3
9	**Fuji-Q Highland has closing days, and its Ferris wheel is closed until January 31, 2027.**	3
10	**Mt. Fuji is often hidden in summer.** In 2025 the whole mountain was visible at 8 a.m. on only 2 days in June.	1
11	**Tattoos:** Fuji Choubou no Yu Yurari says no; Royal Hotel Kawaguchiko says yes.	4
12	**The Kawaguchiko Music Forest Museum is closed on Tuesdays and Wednesdays.**	4

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CHAPTER 1

Before You Go

How to use this guide

This guide is built for one thing: helping you see Mt. Fuji on a day trip from Tokyo, without wasting time on confusing transport or bad timing.

- **Chapter 2** shows you exactly how to get there and back.
- **Chapter 3** covers the 8 places worth your time.
- **Chapter 4** gives you ready-made itineraries you can follow as-is.
- **Chapters 5–6** cover food, manners and the small things that make the day go smoothly.

Every place in this guide is in the Fuji Five Lakes area (Yamanashi Prefecture), the easiest Fuji area to reach from Tokyo.

What if Fuji is hidden?

1. **Check a live camera the night before and the morning of your trip.** For example, Fuji Motosuko Resort (near Lake Motosu) streams a free live camera on YouTube, linked from its official website. No sign-up needed. Search "Fuji Motosuko Resort live camera".
2. **Have a flexible date.** If you have several days in Tokyo, keep the Fuji day movable and pick the clearest forecast.
3. **Use the rainy-day plan in Chapter 4.** The area still has great food, hot springs and museums.

When can you actually see Mt. Fuji?

Mt. Fuji hides behind clouds more often than most visitors expect, so timing matters. Fuji City (Shizuoka Prefecture) checks the mountain every morning at 8 a.m. Here is its record for 2025:

Month	Whole mountain visible	Partly visible	Not visible
Jan	19 days	9	3
Feb	**22 days**	4	2
Mar	13 days	7	11
Apr	9 days	9	12
May	9 days	10	12
Jun	**2 days**	9	19
Jul	5 days	4	22
Aug	3 days	8	20
Sep	6 days	11	13
Oct	10 days	8	13
Nov	19 days	9	2
Dec	19 days	7	5

(Fuji City official "Mt. Fuji observation record", 2025, observed at 8 a.m. from Fuji City Hall.)

In short: from November to February the whole mountain was visible on about two days out of three. From June to August it was fully visible on only a few days a month. This record is from one year and from the Shizuoka side of the mountain, so the Fuji Five Lakes area can differ; always check a live camera before you go.

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CHAPTER 2

Getting There from Tokyo

Option A: Train

The **Fuji Excursion** limited express runs directly from **Shinjuku Station** to **Kawaguchiko Station**.

- Time: about 1 hour 54–58 minutes, no transfers
- Fare: ¥4,200 one way for adults (ticket ¥2,580 + express fee ¥1,620). To Shimoyoshida (for Chureito Pagoda): ¥4,010. (Fujikyu Railway and JR East official sites, checked November 2026.)
- Stops: Shinjuku → Tachikawa → Hachioji → Otsuki → Tsuru-Bunkadaigakumae → **Shimoyoshida (Chureito Pagoda)** → Mt. Fuji → **Fuji-Q Highland** → Kawaguchiko
- Only **4 round trips a day** (plus 1 extra on some dates). There are no non-reserved cars: buy a reserved seat, or a "seat-unspecified" ticket.
- Tickets go on sale **one month before, at 10 a.m.** Book on **"JR-EAST Train Reservation"** (the English booking site for overseas visitors) or Eki-net. Morning trains can be almost full even on weekdays.
- **Important:** The Fuji Excursion is only 3 cars. Between Shinjuku and Otsuki it is coupled to another express train ("Azusa" or "Kaiji"). **Make sure you board Cars 1–3**, or you will end up going somewhere else.

Weekday timetable (from March 14, 2026, Fujikyu official site)**:**

To Kawaguchiko	Leave Shinjuku	Arrive Kawaguchiko
Fuji Excursion 3	7:30	9:28
Fuji Excursion 7	8:30	10:26
Fuji Excursion 11	9:30	11:28
Fuji Excursion 15	10:30	12:24

To Tokyo	Leave Kawaguchiko	Arrive Shinjuku
Fuji Excursion 32	14:08	16:08
Fuji Excursion 36	14:58	16:59
Fuji Excursion 44	16:48	18:48
Fuji Excursion 48	17:41	19:48

Weekend times are different. Always check the latest timetable before booking.

JR Pass users: the nationwide Japan Rail Pass covers Shinjuku–Otsuki only. From Otsuki to Kawaguchiko (Fujikyu Railway) you pay extra: fare ¥1,170 + express fee ¥600 (children ¥400) = ¥1,770 one way. Getting off at Shimoyoshida for Chureito Pagoda: fare ¥980 + express fee ¥600 = ¥1,580. (Fujikyu Railway official fare and fee tables, checked November 2026.) Children pay half the fare (Otsuki–Kawaguchiko ¥590). Suica / PASMO work on the Fujikyu Railway, and the IC card fare is a little cheaper (Otsuki–Kawaguchiko ¥1,161). You can buy the Fujikyu express ticket before boarding or on the train; the price is the same ¥600 either way. If you have no time to buy it, you can pay the difference at the station where you get off. (Confirmed by phone with the Fujikyu call center, November 2, 2026.)

JR TOKYO Wide Pass users: this 3-day pass (for non-Japanese passport holders only) covers the **whole Fujikyu Railway**, so the Fuji Excursion is covered all the way from Shinjuku to Kawaguchiko. Get your free seat reservation at a JR ticket machine or ticket office **before boarding**; without one you may only use empty seats. Extra fees still apply for reserved seats on Fujikyu's own "Fujisan Express" and "Fujisan View Express", and for the "Fuji Tozan Densha" sightseeing train. Carry your original passport while using the pass. (JR East official terms of use, as of March 2026.)

Backup option: If the Fuji Excursion is full, take the "Kaiji" limited express from Shinjuku to **Otsuki**, then change to Fujikyu Railway's own trains to Kawaguchiko. It takes about 20 minutes longer, and the Fujikyu section cannot be booked on Eki-net. On the Fujikyu section you pay the fare (¥1,170) plus, on Fujikyu's own express trains, an express fee of ¥400 (Otsuki–Kawaguchiko). The "Fujisan View Express" also charges ¥200 for a reserved seat in Car 2 or ¥900 for the special Car 1; the "Fujisan Express" charges ¥200 for a reserved seat in Cars 1–2. Note: these

express fees are different from the Fuji Excursion's ¥600. (Fujikyu Railway official fee table, checked November 2026.)

Which side to see Mt. Fuji (Fujikyu Railway section, Otsuki → Kawaguchiko): the view switches sides, so there is no single "best side".

Section	Mt. Fuji is on the
Otsuki → Tsukiedera	Left side (facing the direction of travel)
Tsukiedera → Mt. Fuji Station	Right side
Mt. Fuji Station → Kawaguchiko	Left side

On the way back to Tokyo it is the opposite. (Fujikyu Railway official Q&A, checked November 2026.)

Option B: Highway bus

Buses leave from **Shinjuku Expressway Bus Terminal ("Busta Shinjuku")** and arrive at **Kawaguchiko Station**.

- Time: about 1 hour 45 minutes to Kawaguchiko Station (about 1 hour 40 minutes to Fuji-Q Highland). Traffic can make it longer.
- Fare: ¥2,000–2,200 one way for adults; the lower price is the online discount ("Net-wari"). Standard fare ¥2,200. No round-trip discount. (Highway Bus.com official pages, checked November 2026.)
- The same bus also stops at **Fuji-Q Highland** (same fare), and continues to Oshino Hakkai and Lake Yamanakako. In summer some buses go up to the Mt. Fuji 5th Station.
- Frequency: every 10 minutes to 1 hour
- **No rest stops** on the way, but there is a **toilet on board**. (Fujikyu Bus official FAQ, checked November 2026.)
- **Cancellation:** you can cancel until the bus departs. The fee is ¥110 per one-way ticket (it can differ by route or ticket type). Cancel on the website if you booked online, or at the counter if you bought there. With a round-trip booking you can cancel just one direction. (Fujikyu Bus official FAQ, checked November 2026.)

- **If you miss the bus:** highway buses leave exactly on time. Once the bus has left, your ticket is **void**: no change to a later bus and no refund. If you might be late, change or cancel **before** departure (online, by phone, or at the counter). (Fujikyu Bus official FAQ)
- **Luggage:** one suitcase per person goes free of charge in the luggage space under the bus. (Fujikyu Bus official FAQ)
- **Children:** elementary school age and under pay half the adult fare. One preschool child per adult rides free if they sit on your lap; a child who takes their own seat pays the child fare. (Fujikyu Bus official FAQ)
- You can choose a window or aisle seat when booking, and there are women-only seats.
- Pay online by credit card, or buy at the ticket counters at Busta Shinjuku, Fuji-Q Highland, Kawaguchiko Station and Mt. Fuji Station.
- All seats reserved. Tickets go on sale **one month before, at 10:00 a.m.** After booking online you must pay (credit card, convenience store, etc.) by the deadline shown, or the booking is cancelled automatically. (Fujikyu Bus official FAQ)
- **English help:** the main booking sites (such as Fujiyama Connect) work in English, Chinese and Korean, and the bus ticket counters at Kawaguchiko Station and Mt. Fuji Station may have English- or Chinese-speaking staff. Fujikyu Call Center: 0570-022956. (Fujikyu Bus official FAQ)

Train or bus? Quick comparison

	Train (Fuji Excursion)	Highway bus
Time	About 2 hours, reliable	About 2 hours, traffic-dependent
Price	Higher	Lower
Comfort	More legroom, can walk around	Seat belt required. No rest stops, toilet on board.
Best for	Tight schedules, return trip on busy days	Budget travelers, weekday trips

Our recommendation: Highway buses can be delayed when the roads are busy. If you must be back in Tokyo by a fixed time, the train is the safer choice for the

return trip.

Getting around: the sightseeing buses

From Kawaguchiko Station, sightseeing buses loop around the lakes.

Line	Main stops	Useful for
Red Line (Kawaguchiko area)	Ropeway ("Yuransen / Ropeway Iriguchi" stop), Kawaguchiko Music Forest Museum, Itchiku Kubota Art Museum, Oishi Park ("Kawaguchiko Natural Living Center" stop)	Chapter 3: places 2 and 4
Green Line (Lake Saiko area)	Lake Saiko, Saiko Iyashi-no-Sato Nenba, Saiko Bat Cave, Fugaku Wind Cave (last stop)	Chapter 3: place 5
Blue Line (Narusawa / Lake Shojiko / Lake Motosu)	Mt. Fuji World Heritage Center, Narusawa Ice Cave, Fugaku Wind Cave, Lake Shojiko ("Kodaki Fuji View Point"), Lake Motosu	Chapter 3: place 8

- **Bus passes** ("Kawaguchiko, Saiko, Motosuko Sightseeing Coupon"): unlimited rides on all three lines (Red, Green, Blue) and on regular route buses inside the area (except the Fuji Shibazakura shuttle bus).

Pass	Adults (junior high and up)	Children (elementary school)
1-Day Pass	¥1,500	¥750
2-Day Pass	¥2,000	¥1,000
2-Day Pass + Panoramic Ropeway round trip + Lake Kawaguchiko cruise (or Oishi Park boat line one way)	¥3,300	¥1,650

Buy at the bus ticket office at Kawaguchiko Station, or online on Fujikyu Bus's "Fujiyama Connect" site (online sales close at 12:00 noon on the day of use). The 2-Day Pass is valid for two days from the date you choose. Online cancellation is free until the day before; on the day, the full price is charged. (Fujikyu Bus official site and Fujiyama Connect, checked November 2026.)

- **Single fares on the Red Line (adults):** Kawaguchiko Station to the Ropeway ¥180, to Itchiku Kubota Art Museum ¥440, to Oishi Park (Kawaguchiko Natural Living Center) ¥570. Ropeway to Oishi Park ¥470. (Fujikyu Bus official fare table, checked November 2026.)
- **Single fares on the Green Line (adults):** Kawaguchiko Station to Saiko Iyashi-no-Sato Nenba ¥810. (Fujikyu Bus official fare table, checked November 2026.)
- **Single fares on the Blue Line (adults):** Kawaguchiko Station to Narusawa Ice Cave ¥740, to Fugaku Wind Cave ¥770, to Lake Motosu Tourist Information Center ¥1,470. (Fujikyu Bus official fare table, checked November 2026.) The "Motosuko" stop is also ¥1,470 (confirmed by phone with Fujikyu Bus, November 2, 2026).
- **Is the pass worth it?** If you only ride the Red Line (for example station → Ropeway → Oishi Park → station = ¥1,220), single tickets are cheaper than the ¥1,500 1-Day Pass. But a round trip to Nenba on the Green Line alone costs ¥1,620, and to Lake Motosu ¥2,940, so **buy the 1-Day Pass if you ride the Green or Blue Line**.
- **Mt. FUJI Passport (2 days):** unlimited rides for 2 days on the Red, Green and Blue Lines, the "Fujikko-go" bus (Fujiyoshida, Oshino Hakkai, Lake Yamanakako), the Mt. Fuji World Heritage Loop Bus, regular route buses in the Five Lakes area, **and** the Fujikyu Railway. It also gives discounts at sightseeing spots. There are two types:

Pass	Fujikyu Railway section	Adults	Children
Mt. FUJI Passport	Shimoyoshida – Kawaguchiko	¥3,300	¥1,660
Mt. FUJI Passport "Fujikyu Train Set"	Otsuki – Kawaguchiko (whole line)	¥4,700	¥2,360

Express trains need a separate express ticket, and the "Fuji Tozan Densha" needs a seat ticket. Highway buses and the bus to the Mt. Fuji 5th Station are **not** included. Sold at the Fujikyu Bus counters at Mt. Fuji Station and Kawaguchiko Station (the "Fujikyu Train Set" is also sold at the Fujikyu Railway window at Otsuki Station), and as a mobile ticket. No refunds once you start using it. (Fujikyu Railway official site, checked November 2026.)

- **Tip for JR Pass users:** Otsuki – Kawaguchiko costs ¥1,170 each way on the Fujikyu Railway (¥2,340 round trip). If you also ride the sightseeing buses, the "Fujikyu Train Set" (¥4,700) can cover both.

- **IC cards:** Suica, PASMO, ICOCA and the other nationwide IC cards work on the sightseeing buses. Touch the card reader **when you get on and when you get off**. (Fujikyu Bus official FAQ, checked November 2026.)
- **Children:** elementary school age (6–12) pay the child fare, about half the adult fare. Preschool children (1–5) ride free, one per paying passenger, unless they take their own seat. Junior high school students and older pay the adult fare. (Fujikyu Bus official FAQ)
- **Luggage:** you can bring one bag per person that fits on the rack or your lap. Large suitcases are a problem on these buses (the under-floor luggage space is only on highway buses), so leave big luggage in a coin locker at Kawaguchiko Station first. (Fujikyu Bus official FAQ) Lockers right outside the ticket gates: small ¥700, medium ¥1,000, large ¥1,200 (confirmed by phone with the Fujikyu call center, November 3, 2026).
- **Red Line timetable:** from Kawaguchiko Station, first bus 9:00, then about every 15 minutes, last bus 17:45. Back from Oishi Park, first bus 9:27, last bus 18:27 (arrives at the station 18:54). Oishi Park to the station takes about 27 minutes. (Fujikyu Bus official timetable, checked November 2026.)
- **Green Line timetable:** from Kawaguchiko Station, first bus 9:10, then every 30 minutes, last bus 16:40. Kawaguchiko Station to Saiko Iyashi-no-Sato Nenba takes about 40 minutes; to Fugaku Wind Cave about 49 minutes. (Fujikyu Bus official timetable, checked November 2026.) Back to the station: last bus from Saiko Iyashi-no-Sato Nenba 17:40 (arrives Kawaguchiko Station 18:15); Nenba to the station takes about 35 minutes.
- **Blue Line timetable:** buses are much less frequent (about once an hour, with gaps). From Kawaguchiko Station, first bus 9:35, last bus 15:35. Times from the station: Narusawa Ice Cave about 28 minutes, Fugaku Wind Cave about 39 minutes, Lake Motosu about 57 minutes. Back from Lake Motosu Tourist Information Center: first bus 10:45, last bus 16:45. (Fujikyu Bus official timetable, checked November 2026.) The last bus from Lake Motosu (16:45) arrives at Kawaguchiko Station at 17:45; the ride back takes about 1 hour.

Tip: Chureito Pagoda (place 1) and Oshino Hakkai (place 3) are **not** on these loop lines. See Chapter 3 for how to reach them.

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CHAPTER 3

The 8 Best Places

Each place has a quick info box: how to get there, how long to stay, and the cost.

1. Arakurayama Sengen Park (Chureito Pagoda)

The famous photo: a red five-story pagoda with Mt. Fuji behind it, framed by cherry blossoms in spring. Cherry blossoms are best around **mid-April** and autumn leaves around **mid-November** (approximate; it changes every year). (Confirmed by phone with Fujiyoshida Kanko Shinko Service, November 3, 2026.)

- **Access: Shimoyoshida Station**, then **about 25 minutes on foot** to the pagoda (Chureito), including the stairs. (Fujiyoshida City Tourist Guide, official site, checked November 2026.) The Fuji Excursion from Shinjuku stops here, so you can come straight from Tokyo. From Kawaguchiko it is a short ride on the Fujikyu Railway.
- **Time needed:** 1–1.5 hours
- **Cost: Free** to enter. Only parking costs money: the nearest car park (P1) is ¥1,500 for up to 6 hours. (Confirmed by phone with Fujiyoshida Kanko Shinko Service, November 3, 2026.)
- **Open:** 24 hours. Night illumination: Jan–Feb 16:00–21:50, Mar–Apr 17:00–21:50, May 18:00–21:50, Jun–Sep 19:00–21:50, Oct–Nov 17:00–21:50, Dec 16:00–21:50 (times may change).
- **Good to know:** The viewing deck is at the top of **398 steps**. (Fujiyoshida City Tourist Guide, official site, checked November 2026.)
- **Toilets:** available at the park. The park is now very busy with visitors from overseas, and cars are asked not to drive up to the pagoda square, so walk up from Shimoyoshida Station. (Fujiyoshida City Tourist Guide, official site)

2. Lake Kawaguchiko North Shore (Oishi Park)

The classic "Fuji across the lake" view, with flowers from spring to autumn. It is famous for lavender.

Flower	Usually at its best
Nemophila (blue)	mid-April – late May
Roses	late May – mid-June
Lavender	**late June – mid-July**
Casablanca lilies	early – late July
Kochia (green)	early August – mid-October
Kochia (red)	**early – late October**

Dates change every year; the official site posts the current flower status.
(Fujikawaguchiko Furusato Shinko Foundation official site, checked November 2026.)

- **Access:** Red Line sightseeing bus, **"Kawaguchiko Natural Living Center (Oishi Park)"** stop, the last stop of the line (Fujikyu Bus official timetable)
- **Time needed:** 1 hour
- **Cost:** the Kawaguchiko Natural Living Center is free to enter, and parking is free. (Foundation official site) The park itself is **free and open at all times**, with no closing days. (Fujikawaguchiko Town Tourism Federation official site, checked November 2026.)
- **Facilities:** the Kawaguchiko Natural Living Center, the "Ooishiya" farm produce stand, a gazebo, a playground and a large parking lot. **Toilets (wheelchair accessible) are inside the Natural Living Center.** (Fujikawaguchiko Town official site, checked November 2026.)
- **Please note:** there are **no trash bins** in the park, so take your trash with you. Dogs must be on a leash. (Fujikawaguchiko Town official site)
- **Snacks:** soft-serve ice cream at "Oishi Park Cafe" (12 flavors, all ¥550 as of November 2026; **blueberry and lavender** are the regular flavors, others change with the season). Local Oishi blueberry juice ¥800 at the "Mt. Fuji View Cafe". Upstairs, "Kitchen Fujiyama View" has a big window facing Mt. Fuji and sells "Cremia" premium soft-serve, Mt. Fuji–shaped ice candy and roasted

sweet potatoes (¥500). Prices and menus change. (Foundation official site, checked November 2026.)

- **Souvenirs:** Mt. Fuji goods, Yamanashi crafts and handmade blueberry jam.
- **Natural Living Center hours:** open every day. November–February: shop 9:00–17:15, cafes and soft-serve 9:15–16:15, Kitchen Fujiyama View 9:00–16:30. Other months the cafes stay open until 16:45 and the Kitchen until 17:00. Phone 0555-76-8230. (Foundation official site)

3. Oshino Hakkai

Eight spring-fed ponds of crystal-clear water. Snow that falls on Mt. Fuji soaks into the ground and is filtered through layers of lava for **decades** before it comes up here. The ponds were once sacred: pilgrims purified themselves here before climbing Mt. Fuji. Oshino Hakkai is a **Natural Monument of Japan** (1934), one of Japan's **100 best waters** (1985), and part of the **Mt. Fuji World Cultural Heritage** site (2013). (Oshino Village Tourism Association official site, checked November 2026.)

- **Access:**
  - From **Mt. Fuji Station** (Fujikyu Railway): Fujikyu route bus, about 15–25 minutes. (Oshino Village Tourism Association official access page, checked November 2026; the page gives both times.) The "Fujikko-go" bus, covered by the Mt. FUJI Passport, also runs to Oshino Hakkai.
  - Direct from **Shinjuku**: the Chuo Highway Bus to the Fuji Five Lakes continues past Fuji-Q Highland to Oshino Hakkai, about 2 hours 20 minutes in total. (Official access page)
  - From **Kawaguchiko Station** (buses start here; get off at **"Oshino Hakkai"**):
    - **Route bus:** lines **A1 / A2** (for Gotemba) or **F1 / F2** (for Yamanakako Hirano), 1–2 buses an hour. First bus from Kawaguchiko Station around **6:50**.
    - **Express bus:** about 10 minutes faster and about ¥200–300 more than the route bus. Leaves Kawaguchiko Station every hour from 9:40 to 16:40, **except 12:40**.
    - (Confirmed by phone with the Oshino Village Tourist Information Center, November 3, 2026.)
- **Time needed:** 1 hour

- **Open:** there is no gate and no opening hours, so you can visit any time. But there are few street lights, so walking around **after dark is not recommended**. (Oshino Village Tourism Association official Q&A, checked November 2026.)
- **Cost:** free to walk around. One of the eight ponds, **Sokonuke-ike**, is inside the **Hannoki-bayashi Museum** and can only be seen when the museum is open (phone 0555-84-2587). The museum is set in the grounds of an old local family's house, with **thatched-roof farmhouses** thought to date from the 18th century, among the oldest in the Mt. Fuji area. It also has a restaurant serving hoto noodles and soba. Museum hours 9:00–17:00; restaurant 10:30–17:00 (closes early when food runs out). Closed on irregular days (bad weather, family events). Museum admission (tax included): adults (junior high and up) ¥300, children (elementary school) ¥150, small children (age 1 to kindergarten) ¥100; groups of 15 or more get ¥50 off each. Inside you can see the Watanabe family's late-18th-century farmhouse, Edo-period samurai armor and swords, old farm tools and a 1582 document from the Hojo clan. Local legend says Sokonuke-ike ("bottomless pond") is connected underground to Okama-ike: things dropped here were said to float up there. (Hannoki-bayashi official site, checked November 2026.)
- **Wheelchairs:** free wheelchair loan at the tourist information center (only 3, so book ahead: 0555-84-4221). Most ponds can be reached by wheelchair, but **Okama-ike** (down stairs) and **Shobu-ike** (rough path) cannot, and Deguchi-ike is far from the others. (Official Q&A)
- **Pets:** allowed on a leash; carry them or use a cage inside shops. (Official Q&A)
- **Winter:** snow usually falls from late November to March, and shady spots can be icy even without snow. (Official Q&A)
- **Tourist information center:** 0555-84-4222 (weekdays 9:00–17:00, weekends and holidays 9:00–16:00). (Oshino Village Tourism Association official site)
- **Rules:** you may touch the water, but **throwing coins into the ponds is prohibited**.
- **Crowds:** busiest from about **10:30 to 14:30**; quieter before and after. (Both confirmed by phone with the Oshino Village Tourist Information Center, November 3, 2026.)

4. Mt. Fuji Panoramic Ropeway (Mt. Tenjo)

A ropeway up from the shore of Lake Kawaguchiko. At the top: wide views of Mt. Fuji and the lake.

- **Access:** Red Line sightseeing bus, **"Yuransen / Ropeway Iriguchi"** stop, about 11 minutes from Kawaguchiko Station (Fujikyu Bus official timetable). Or about **15 minutes on foot** from Kawaguchiko Station.
- **Time needed:** 1 hour
- **Cost:** round trip adults ¥1,200, children ¥600; one way adults ¥800, children ¥400.
- **Hours:** change with the season; usually **8:30–17:30**. Hours are shorter on inspection days.
- (Fares, hours and walking time confirmed by phone with Mt. Fuji Panoramic Ropeway, November 3, 2026.)

5. Saiko Iyashi-no-Sato Nenba

A rebuilt village of thatched-roof houses with Mt. Fuji in the background.

- **Access:** Green Line sightseeing bus, **"Saiko Iyashi-no-Sato Nenba"** stop, about 40 minutes from Kawaguchiko Station. Buses every 30 minutes; last bus from the station 16:40. (Fujikyu Bus official timetable)
- **Time needed:** 1–1.5 hours
- **Cost:** high school students and adults ¥500, elementary and junior high students ¥250, preschool children free.
- **Hours:** through November 9:00–17:00 (last entry 16:30); December–February 9:30–16:30 (last entry 16:00).
- (Admission and hours confirmed by phone with Saiko Iyashi-no-Sato Nenba, November 3, 2026.)

6. Fuji Subaru Line 5th Station

Ride a bus up onto the slopes of Mt. Fuji itself.

- **Access:** Direct Fujikyu bus from Kawaguchiko Station, about **1 hour** one way. The bus runs whenever the road is open; when Yamanashi Prefecture closes the Fuji Subaru Line (for example in bad weather or snow), the bus does not run. (Confirmed by phone with Fujikyu Bus, November 3, 2026.)

- **Time needed:** 1.5–2 hours
- **Cost:** bus **¥2,000 one way** for adults. (Confirmed by phone with Fujikyu Bus, November 3, 2026.)
- **Good to know:** check that the road is open before you go.

7. Fuji-Q Highland

An amusement park at the foot of Mt. Fuji, famous for its roller coasters.

- **Access:** Fujikyu Railway, **Fuji-Q Highland Station**, the stop just before Kawaguchiko; the Fuji Excursion stops here too. The highway bus from Busta Shinjuku also stops at Fuji-Q Highland. (Fujikyu Railway and Highway Bus.com official sites, checked November 2026.)
- **Time needed:** Half a day to a full day
- **Cost: entry is free**; you pay for rides (single ride tickets from machines inside the park, or a ride pass). Pass prices change by date:

Pass	Adults (18–64)	Junior high & high school	Elementary school	Age 1+ / 65+
One-Day Pass (unlimited rides)	¥6,000–7,900	¥5,500–7,400	¥4,400–5,100	¥2,100–2,600
Afternoon Pass (from 13:00)	¥4,100–6,000	¥3,800–5,700	¥3,500–4,200	¥1,700–2,100

Buy online or at the park. No refunds or changes after purchase, and some rides are not covered by the passes. Check the monthly price calendar on the official site before you go. (Fuji-Q Highland official site, checked November 2026.)

- **Opening hours:** change every day, and **the park is closed on some days**. For example, in January 2027 it opens 9:00–19:00 on New Year holidays but mostly 10:00–17:00, and is closed on several Wednesdays and Thursdays (January 13, 14, 20, 21, 27 and 28). Some rides also close for inspection on certain days. **Always check the monthly calendar on the official site before you go.** (Fuji-Q Highland official site, January 2027 calendar, checked November 2026.)
- **Closed for construction:** the Ferris wheel (until January 31, 2027), "Tentekomai" (until late July 2027, planned) and "Red Tower" (until further notice). (Fuji-Q Highland official site)

8. Lake Motosu (the ¥1,000 bill view)

The view of Mt. Fuji printed on the back of the old ¥1,000 bill.

- **Access:** Blue Line sightseeing bus to **"Lake Motosu Tourist Information Center"** (about 1 hour from Kawaguchiko Station, adult fare ¥1,470), then **about 1 hour on foot** to the viewpoint near **Koansō (浩庵荘)**. Show the Japanese name to locals if you need directions. (Bus stop, fare and walking time confirmed by phone with Fujikyu Bus, November 2, 2026.) Buses run only about once an hour; last bus from Kawaguchiko Station 15:35, last bus back from the Tourist Information Center 16:45. (Fujikyu Bus official timetable)
- **Plan carefully:** with the 1-hour walk each way, you need about 3 hours here. Take a morning bus, and start walking back from the viewpoint by about 15:30 so you do not miss the last bus.
- **Time needed:** about 3 hours including the walk (plus bus waiting time)
- **Cost:** Free
- **Good to know:** every spring the **Fuji Shibazakura Festival** is held at **Fuji Motosuko Resort** near the lake: about 500,000 pink moss phlox plants in front of Mt. Fuji. In 2026 it ran from April 11 to May 24 (dates depend on the flowers and change every year). Check the official Fuji Motosuko Resort site for the dates and admission. (Fuji Motosuko Resort official site, checked November 2026.)

行程

CHAPTER 4

Ready-Made Itineraries

All times assume you arrive at Kawaguchiko Station around 10:30 a.m. and leave around 5 p.m.

Course A: Relaxed day (first-timers)

Time	Plan
10:30	Arrive at Kawaguchiko Station. This course uses only the Red Line, so single tickets are cheaper than the 1-Day Pass (Chapter 2).
11:00	Mt. Fuji Panoramic Ropeway (place 4)
12:30	Lunch: hoto noodles near the station (Chapter 5)
14:00	Red Line bus to Oishi Park (place 2)
15:30	Bus back to the station, souvenir shopping
17:00	Train or bus back to Tokyo

Course B: Photo lover's day

Time	Plan
7:30	Fuji Excursion 3 from Shinjuku, get off at Shimoyoshida
9:13	Arrive at Shimoyoshida Station (weekdays and weekends; Fujikyu Railway official timetable from March 14, 2026)
9:40	Chureito Pagoda (place 1), about 25 minutes on foot from the station
12:00	Lunch: Yoshida udon near Shimoyoshida (Chapter 5)
13:30	Back to Kawaguchiko, Red Line bus to Oishi Park (place 2)
14:45	Red Line bus back from Oishi Park to Kawaguchiko Station (about 27 minutes)

Time	Plan
15:40	Green Line bus from Kawaguchiko Station, arrive Saiko Iyashi-no-Sato Nenba (place 5) at 16:20. Last entry is 16:30, so do not miss this bus. **December–February the last entry is 16:00: take the 15:10 bus instead (arrives about 15:50).**
17:10	Green Line bus back from Nenba, arrive Kawaguchiko Station 17:45. **The last bus from Nenba is 17:40** (arrives 18:15).

Course C: Rainy-day plan

Time	Plan
10:30	Arrive at Kawaguchiko Station
11:00	Kawaguchiko Music Forest Museum or Itchiku Kubota Art Museum (indoor; see below. The Music Forest Museum is closed on Tuesdays and Wednesdays)
13:00	Lunch: hoto noodles
14:30	Day-trip hot spring: Fuji Choubou no Yu Yurari (**no tattoos**) or Royal Hotel Kawaguchiko (**tattoos OK**); see below
16:30	Back to the station

Rainy-day museums

- **Itchiku Kubota Art Museum:** kimono art by Itchiku Kubota. Adults ¥1,500; high school and university students ¥900; elementary and junior high students ¥400. Open 10:00–17:00 (last entry 16:30). Closing days change every month, so check the calendar on the museum's official website. Red Line bus, "Kubota Itchiku Bijutsukan" stop, adult fare ¥440 from Kawaguchiko Station. (Admission and hours confirmed by phone with the museum, November 3, 2026.)
- **Kawaguchiko Music Forest Museum:** European-style gardens and buildings with antique music boxes and automatic musical instruments. Weekday admission: adults ¥1,800; high school and university students ¥1,300; elementary and junior high students ¥1,000; preschool children free. On Saturdays and Sundays, adults and high school/university students pay ¥300 more; elementary and junior high students stay ¥1,000. Open 10:00–17:30 (last entry 17:00). **Closed on Tuesdays and Wednesdays**, with more closing days

from January to March, so check the museum's official website. Red Line bus, "Kawaguchiko Music Forest Museum" stop. (Admission, hours and closing days confirmed by phone with the museum, November 3, 2026.)

Rainy-day hot spring

- **Fuji Choubou no Yu Yurari** (Narusawa, next to "Michi-no-Eki Narusawa" on the Blue Line): a day-trip hot spring with views of Mt. Fuji.
  - Admission: weekdays adults ¥1,400, children ¥750; Saturdays, Sundays and holidays adults ¥1,700, children ¥800. Junior high students and older pay the adult price.
  - Hours: weekdays 10:00–21:00 (last entry 20:00); Saturdays, Sundays and holidays open one hour longer (last entry 21:00). Closed only twice a year.
  - **Tattoos: not allowed**, even if covered. If you have a tattoo, choose Royal Hotel Kawaguchiko (below) or the museums instead.
  - Free shuttle bus from Kawaguchiko Station: book on the official website. For the ride back, ask at the front desk.
  - (All confirmed by phone with Yurari, November 3, 2026.)
- **Royal Hotel Kawaguchiko — tattoo-friendly:** day-trip bathing is allowed **with tattoos**.
  - Admission (2 hours): adults ¥1,850 with bath towel or ¥1,000 without; children ¥1,650 with towel or ¥800 without.
  - Hours: 5:00 to 1:00 at night, except **9:30–11:30 (cleaning, no entry)**. Generally no closing days.
  - The hotel shuttle bus is **for overnight guests only**. Day visitors: about **18 minutes on foot** from Kawaguchiko Station, or about 8–9 minutes by the Red Line or Green Line sightseeing bus (¥180). (Google Maps, November 2026.)
  - (All confirmed by phone with Royal Hotel Kawaguchiko, November 3, 2026.)

味

CHAPTER 5

Local Food

Hoto

Thick, flat wheat noodles simmered with pumpkin and vegetables in a miso soup, served bubbling in an iron pot. Warm and filling, perfect on a cold day.

- **Price:** depends on the restaurant, and prices go up from time to time. Example: at Hōtō Kura Fujinari (Kawaguchiko), the signature "Golden Hōtō" with pork or chicken is ¥1,815 (restaurant's own menu on Google, November 2026). Check the menu at the shop. Hōtō Kura Fujinari: 6931 Funatsu, Fujikawaguchiko.
- **How to eat:** It arrives very hot. Use the small bowl to cool each portion.
- **Vegetarian?** The soup may contain fish stock. Ask: *"Dashi ni sakana wa haitte imasu ka?"* (Is there fish in the broth?)

Yoshida Udon

Fujiyoshida's local udon: very thick and very firm. It is served in a soy-miso soup with cabbage and seasoned horse meat or beef.

- **Price:** cheap. Example: at **Miura Udon** (near Shimoyoshida Station, handy after Chureito Pagoda), most bowls are up to about ¥900, and the most popular "niku udon" (horse meat and cabbage) is about ¥700. Extra noodles about ¥300. (Menu listed on Google, November 2026; prices may change.)

How to order

- Many restaurants use a **ticket machine** at the entrance. Pay first, give the ticket to the staff.
- Pointing at the menu photo is perfectly fine.
- Tipping is not expected in Japan.

心得

CHAPTER 6

Good to Know

Avoiding crowds

- Arrive by 9–10 a.m. Tour buses arrive late morning.
- Visit Chureito Pagoda first, before 9 a.m. if possible.
- Weekdays are much quieter than weekends and Japanese holidays.

Photo manners

The area has had serious problems with overtourism. Locals will appreciate it if you:

- Do not stand in the road or block traffic for photos.
- Do not enter private property or shops just to take pictures.
- Keep your voice down in residential areas.
- Take your trash with you. There are very few public bins in Japan.

Money, toilets and luggage

- **Cash and IC cards:** Suica, PASMO and other IC cards work on the Fujikyu Railway and the sightseeing buses (Chapter 2). Some small shops and restaurants may only take cash, so carry some cash as well.
- **Toilets:** Free, clean toilets at stations, parks and convenience stores.
- **Luggage:** coin lockers **right outside the ticket gates** at Kawaguchiko Station, including ones big enough for a suitcase. Small ¥700, medium ¥1,000, large ¥1,200. (Confirmed by phone with the Fujikyu call center, November 3, 2026.) Leave big luggage here before riding the sightseeing buses.

Useful Japanese phrases

English	Japanese (say it like this)
Hello	Konnichiwa
Thank you	Arigatou gozaimasu
Excuse me / Sorry	Sumimasen
Where is the toilet?	Toire wa doko desu ka?
How much is this?	Kore wa ikura desu ka?
One ticket to Kawaguchiko, please	Kawaguchiko made ichi-mai kudasai
Can I pay by card?	Kaado de haraemasu ka?

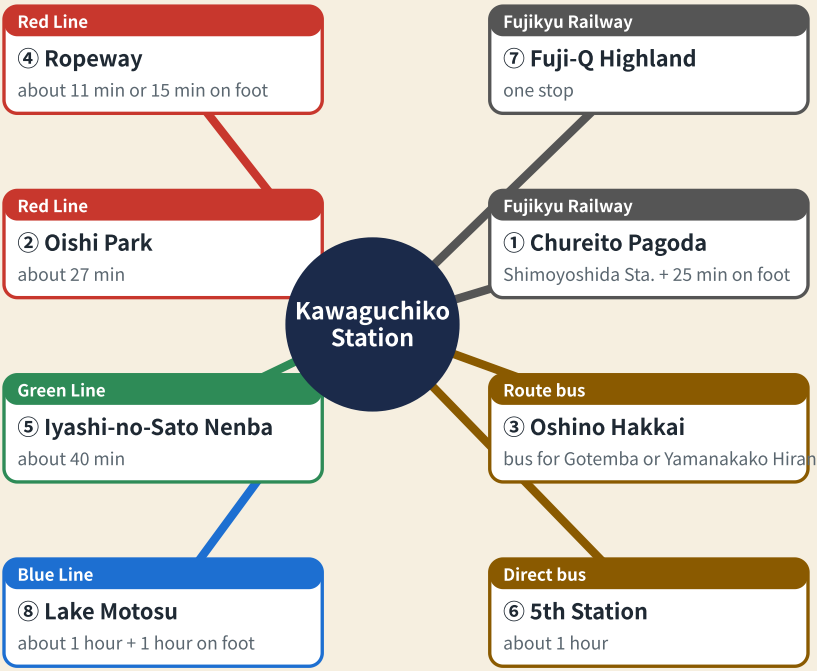
Packing checklist

- ☐ Train or bus ticket (booked in advance)
- ☐ Some cash (small shops may be cash only)
- ☐ IC card (Suica / PASMO)
- ☐ Warm jacket
- ☐ Comfortable walking shoes (398 steps at Chureito Pagoda)
- ☐ Phone battery pack
- ☐ Small bag for your trash
- ☐ Umbrella or rain jacket

地図

EXTRAS

Getting Around: Route Diagram



⇧ To Tokyo (Shinjuku): Fuji Excursion / Highway bus (Chapter 2)

Diagram only. Distances and positions are not to scale. All times are from Chapters 2 and 3.